

Paul Sweeney

DEVOPS & PLATFORM ENGINEERING LEAD

Sherborne, Dorset, UK | +44 7970 044442 | paulsweeneycv@kolossi.co.uk | <https://www.linkedin.com/in/paulsweeneycv/>

PROFILE

Experienced engineering professional with a long track record of building and running reliable delivery platforms. Strong background in modernising legacy systems, supporting cloud adoption, and putting practical engineering platforms in place that teams actually use. Acknowledged as fixing hard technical problems, improving stability, and providing clear technical direction when things are unclear. Brings hands-on experience across build, test, deployment, observability, and release, and works closely with engineers to raise standards and introduce automation that reduces operational effort and long-term cost.

CORE COMPETENCIES/TECHNICAL PROFICIENCIES

DevOps & Cloud Platforms: Kubernetes, K8S, AKS, GKE, KubeVela, Docker, Azure DevOps, Git, Helm, Crossplane, Linux, Ubuntu, IIS
Automation & Scripting: Terraform, Pulumi, Argo, Ansible, Bash, PowerShell, Python, CI/CD, Octopus Deploy, TeamCity, GoCD
Monitoring & Observability: Prometheus, Grafana, Alertmanager, Thanos, Datadog, Graylog, Headlamp
Developer Platforms / IDP/ DevEx: Backstage, Internal Developer Platforms, Platform Engineering, AgenticAI, Agentic Coding
Programming & Engineering: C#, .NET, .NET Core, ASP.NET, Multithreading, SQL, XML, REST API, Microservices, C++, C, SaaS
Networks & Infrastructure: Cisco, CCNA, WAN, MPLS, BGP, VPN, IPSEC, SNMP, Entra ID/Azure AD, PKCE, SSO, RBAC

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Meddbase, Part of Cority Group, Remote 2026 – 2026
Senior Platform Engineer

Brought modern cloud-native platform practices to a legacy IIS-based codebase, migrating services to Kubernetes and hardening authentication, security, and observability.

Key Contributions:

- Introduced a platform migrating legacy IIS-based services to AKS deployment using KubeVela, executed directly from within the existing monolith repository.
- Implemented observability with CNCF Headlamp and Prometheus, Thanos, and Grafana; applied using Argo.
- Enhanced cluster stability by tuning CPU and Memory resource specifications.
- Upgraded authentication from certificate-based to PKCE/SSO using Pulumi, enabling Entra ID (Azure AD) group-based RBAC.

TravelRepublic, Part of Emirates Group, Remote 2013 – 2026
Senior Developer, DevOps Platform Engineering Lead (2019 – 2026)

Lead strategic direction across platform engineering landscape, guiding technical decision-making, modernisation initiatives, and engineering alignment across multi-cloud environments. Manage Kubernetes platforms across six self-managed clusters, ensuring automated provisioning, resilience patterns, and consistent operational integrity through advanced observability tooling. Direct release governance by defining branching strategy, communication channels, and pipeline automation while stewarding broader deployment estate through TeamCity, GoCD, and Octopus systems. Strengthen architecture foundations through systematic refactoring, unit-test enablement, and code-base modernisation, including significant migration of legacy components into C#.

Key Contributions:

- Championed early adoption of AgenticAI Coding by producing practical introductory material and offering hands-on guidance, demonstrating to colleagues and managers the time savings and quality improvements possible.
- Reduced operational complexity through consolidation of legacy deployment tooling into a more coherent & maintainable platform, gaining modern features and reducing contact points required by developers.
- Elevated software quality by restructuring critical components to support unit testing and by migrating over 250,000 lines of code from VB.NET to C#, reducing dependency on legacy skillsets and increasing maintainability.
- Established a unified standard pipeline improving DevOps consistency across Linux & Windows build, deploy & monitoring processes, allowing over 100 workloads to go from first local code to AKS/GKE multicloud Kubernetes production deploy in minutes or hours rather than previous weeks or months of unnecessary learning curve.
- Boosted production resilience by managing six bare-metal Kubernetes clusters, created with an Ansible playbook implementing Prometheus, Grafana, and AlertManager with Slack/Teams notifications, giving zero downtime in 6 years of peak trading periods.

Acumentive Ltd, Remote Software Development Lead

Joined as the sole technical consultant & developer, working directly with the Managing Director on everything from customer-facing technical discussions to pre- and post-sales support and hands-on development. Wrote Python utility scripts to simplify product build and testing within a third-party framework. Designed and built a common C# application framework to speed up delivery and allow flexible configuration across different hardware and backend systems, supporting Windows, web, and Compact Framework mobile deployments backed by SQL Server. As the work grew, built and led the technical team of four consultants.

Key Contributions:

- Acted as a key technical lead, keeping up-to-date knowledge of core technologies and maintaining steady working relationships with suppliers in RFID, Ultrasonic ID, and Real-Time Location Systems, allowing several industry-leading projects through strong partnerships.
- Supported the organisation's pioneering remote working model by putting practical systems in place for bug tracking, project management, wiki collaboration, change control, data back-ups, and DVCS version control, increasing transparency and manageability despite the distributed nature of the company.
- Improved testing and demonstration work by introducing Virtual Machine tools such as Virtual PC and VMWare allowing the MD & sales lead to demo to clients with repeatability and confidence.

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

.NET E-Commerce Developer | Commercial Services, Kent County Council, UK

Lead Developer & Website Testing Consultant | SciVisum Ltd, Sittingbourne, Kent, UK

Software Development Engineer | Viewgate Networks, Sevenoaks, Kent, UK

EDUCATION & PROFESSIONAL ACCREDITATIONS

Chartered Engineer (CEng) | Engineering Council

Institution Member (MIET) | Institute of Engineering and Technology (formerly IEE)

Master of Electrical & Electronic Engineering (MEng) | Imperial College, London, UK

TECHNICAL CERTIFICATIONS

Linux Foundation CKA | Kubernetes Admin

Cisco CCNA | Network Admin

OPEN-SOURCE CONTRIBUTIONS & COMMUNITY INVOLVEMENT

CNCF KubeVela Project | Contributor | GitHub & Slack community

A Hello World for AgenticAI Coding | Creator | YouTube - https://youtu.be/t88im_V3zQg

K9S (Kubernetes CLI UI) | Contributor | Github & Slack community

Ansible-Role-Pi-K8S (RPi4 Kubernetes cluster installer) | Author | GitHub

Kolossi.EasyLife null-tolerant LINQ library | Author | NuGet & GitHub

Kube-Prometheus documentation | Contributor | GitHub

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Previously voluntary roles | Parent Governor, Parish Councillor

Pickleball player | DUPR rating 3.0-3.5

Private Pilot Licence | JAA-PPL(A)/SEP